

INDIANAPOLIS COLTS

INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — \$88M says Daniel Jones is the starter, three key players are rehabbing surgeries, and Anthony Richardson is back in the building.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

Daniel Jones	3	Sauce Gardner	\$114M	PUP
2 YR / \$88M	KEY PLAYERS POST-SURGERY	COST TWO 1STS	PIERCE CONTRACT	PIERCE & BUCKNER WATCH

◆ FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **The Colts committed to Daniel Jones** on a **two-year, \$88M** deal — an emphatic answer to a quarterback question that has followed this franchise for years.
- ◆ **Anthony Richardson Sr. returned.** He **requested a trade** earlier in the offseason, then came back during the voluntary program and drew praise from coaches and teammates for his professionalism and mentality.
- ◆ **Last year's bill is still being paid.** Indianapolis traded **two first-round picks** for CB Sauce Gardner — the kind of move that removes any patience from the timeline.
- ◆ **The pass rush was allowed to leave.** Kwity Paye and Samson Ebukam both walked in free agency, an unusual choice for a team otherwise pushing chips in.

◆ TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **SIGNED** **Daniel Jones, QB** — two years, \$88M, back as the unambiguous starter.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **Alec Pierce, WR** — four years, **\$114M** on March 9, one of the largest receiver contracts of the offseason.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **EDGE Arden Key** — the veteran expected to absorb some of the vacated pass-rush role.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **S Thomas** from Dallas, joining a safety room that was thin behind Cam Bynum.
- ◆ **LOST** **EDGE Kwity Paye** and **EDGE Samson Ebukam** (to Atlanta) both departed in free agency.

◆ PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **Daniel Jones, QB.** Rehabbed an **Achilles** this offseason and is **expected to be ready for the start of camp**, operating the starting offense in team sessions from day one.
- ◆ **Alec Pierce, WR.** Signed for \$114M in March, then underwent a **"clean-up procedure" on his left ankle**. A candidate to open camp on **PUP**.
- ◆ **DeForest Buckner, DT.** Rehabbing a **neck** issue and also a PUP candidate — the third influential Colt coming off surgery.
- ◆ **Anthony Richardson Sr., QB.** Trade request behind him, back in the building, and by all accounts handling a backup role the right way. How the room shakes out behind Jones is a genuine camp question.
- ◆ **Riley Leonard, QB.** The third name in a quarterback room the team's own preview treats as unsettled beyond QB1.
- ◆ **Arden Key, EDGE.** Carrying more than a veteran signing usually does, given who left.

◆ LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Daniel Jones, QB	Re-signed — 2 yr / \$88M
▲ Alec Pierce, WR	4 yr / \$114M signed March 9
▲ Arden Key, EDGE	Veteran pass-rush signing
▲ Thomas, S	Signed from Dallas
▲ Anthony Richardson Sr., QB	Returned after an offseason trade request
▼ Kwity Paye, EDGE	Left in free agency
▼ Samson Ebukam, EDGE	Signed with Atlanta

◆ THE BOTTOM LINE

Indianapolis has spent aggressively in every direction — two first-round picks for Sauce Gardner, \$88M for Daniel Jones, \$114M for Alec Pierce — and now waits to see who is healthy enough to use it. **Jones (Achilles), Pierce (ankle) and Buckner (neck) all spent the offseason rehabbing**, with two of them PUP candidates. Meanwhile the edge rush walked out the door. It is a roster with a very high ceiling and an unusually large number of medical asterisks.